

Business Analyst Task, [M.Rajasimha](#), Meru Technosoft

Task 1- AI Bookkeeping Competitor Research:

Company name	Year of start	Company size	associated members	Recent funding	Funding type	Total funding
BotKeeper	2015	51-200 employees	356	42M	Series C	89.5M
Vic.ai	2017	51-200 employees	103	52M	Series C	114.7M
Zeni	2019	201-500 employees	337	34M	Series B	47.5M
Bench	2012	201-500	334	60M	Series C	109.4M
Xero	2006	1,000-5000 employees	6,140	925m	Post-IPO Debt	1.6B

PRICING:

Company name	Basic pricing	Advance pricing	Rating	Group of users
BotKeeper	\$69	\$215	4.4	30
Vic.ai	\$25,000	\$50,000	4.7	25
Zeni	\$494	\$719	4.7	73
Bench	\$299	\$549	4.5	310
xero	\$29	\$69	4.4	3,222

1) BOTKEEPER:

Core Features:

- Smart Connect

- Transaction Manager
- Auto Bank Rec
- JE Automation
- Close Tracker
- Activity hub
- Firm Insight

Marketing, sales, or product strategies:

- Primary growth engine is a B2B sales and partnership strategy aimed at accounting firms, built around a product strategy of AI-powered automation to deliver more efficient and accurate bookkeeping.

2) Vic.ai:

Core Features:

- AI-First & Autonomous Finance
- Agentic AI
- Comprehensive AP Suite
- Additional financial tools (VICPAY, VICCARD)

Marketing, sales, or product strategies:

- The strategy is to build a full, end-to-end -Autonomous Finance Platform.
- Their primary growth engine is a B2B sales strategy targeting enterprise-level finance teams.

3) ZENI:

Core Features:

- Hybrid Human-AI model
- Comprehensive Financial Suite (AI Bookkeeping agents, Financial Services & Products)
- Real time Insights

Marketing, sales, or product strategies:

- Their primary growth engine is a B2C (business-to-consumer) sales strategy targeting startup founders.
- The strategy is to build a full-stack financial operations platform that integrates software and services.

4) BENCH:

Core Features:

- Hybrid Model (AI + Human Intelligence)
- All in one back-office platform (bookkeeping, tax services, tax credit Discovery)

Marketing, sales, or product strategies:

- Their primary growth engine is a B2C strategy aimed at small businesses.
- They use a product-led growth (PLG) model by offering a "30-day free trial" and a "free" getting started option.
- The strategy is one of vertical integration and horizontal expansion. They started with bookkeeping, then added complementary services (tax, tax credits), and are now building their own financial products.

5) XERO:

Core Features:

- Simplicity and Automation.
- Extensive App Ecosystem
- Global presence & local focus

Marketing, sales, or product strategies:

- A significant part of Xero's sales strategy is its deep partnership with accountants and bookkeepers.
- They also use a direct sales approach through their website, offering a free trial to attract new business owners.
- The company's business model is "Software-as-a-Service," with a platform approach.

Comparison:

Feature / Issue	Botkeeper	Vic.ai	Zeni	Bench	Xero
Automation Efficiency / AI-driven	✓	✓	✓	✗	✗
Easy Tracking / Ease of Use	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Integration Features	✓	✗ (ERP gaps)	✗ (limited global)	✗ (CRM issues)	✓ (wide apps)
Scalability	✓	✓	✓	✗	✓
Dashboard / UI	✗	✗	✓	✗	✓
Human Expertise / Support Team	✗	✗	✓	✓	✗
Transparent / Affordable Pricing	✗ (expensive)	✗ (depends on ERP)	✓	✓	✗ (price hikes)
Financial Reporting	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Onboarding Complexity	✗	✓	✓	✓	✓
Bank / Software Issues	✗	✗	✓	✓	✗ (bugs/import fails)
Customer Support	✓	✓	✓	✓	✗

COMPETITOR RESEARCH:

1) BOTKEEPER Pros and Cons:

PROS

- Automation Efficiency
- Easy Tracking
- Integration Features
- Scalability

Cons

- Onboarding complexity (setup can be time-consuming and confusing)
- software/bank issues (Occasional disruptions with bank integrations)
- Cost Concerns (few noted it's more expensive than expected)

2) Vic.ai Pros and Cons:

Pros

- Strong Ai-driven automation
- Time Savings & Efficiency
- Ease of use
- Accuracy & error Reduction
- Scalability

Cons

- Integration Gaps (no direct integration with some ERP's)
- Email & Notification Issue (email goes to spam)
- Occasional Errors (Sometimes falsely shows duplicate invoices)

3) ZENI Pros and Cons

Pros

- Great Dashboard/UI
- Combines AI speed and with human expertise
- Highly responsive, knowledgeable support team
- Transparent Pricing

- Save significant time and efforts

Cons

- Limited global flexibility
- Complex/unique transaction
- Occasional glitches

4) BENCH Pros and Cons

Pros

- Hands-off bookkeeping services (minimal efforts)
- Bank & software integration (connects directly with bank)
- Financial Report (provides monthly/annual report)
- Quick Response
- Affordable

Cons

- Limited integration (doesn't work well with all the CRMs)
- Delay in providing monthly reports

5) Xero Pros and Cons

Pros

- User friendly interface
- Cloud – based accessibility (Xero is a cloud-based platform)
- Integration (it integrates with wide range of third-party apps)
- Core functionality (invoicing, expense tracking, basic financial report)

Cons

- Lack of customer support (extremely poor customer service)
- Price increase and removing feature (Frequently price hike changes, functionality removal)
- Limited customization (Customization options are not robust)
- Technical Issue (various bugs, fails to import transaction)

Research:

HelloBooks.ai											
Logos	Company name	Year of start	Company size	associated members	Rating	Group of users	Funding type	Recent funding	Total funding	Basic pricing	Advance pricing
	Bench	2012	201-500 employees	334	4.50	310	Series C	60M	109.4M	299	549
	BotKeeper	2015	51-200 employees	356	4.40	30	Series C	42M	89.5M	69	215
	Vikai	2017	51-200 employees	103	4.70	25	Series C	52M	114.7M	25000	50000
	xero	2006	1,000-5000 employees	6140	4.40	3222	Post-IPO Debt	925m	1.6B	29	69
	Zeni	2019	201-500 employees	337	4.70	73	Series B	34M	47.5M	494	719

Growth Timeline:

1) BOTKEEPER

Company Funding

Funding Rounds

Investors

Total Funding Amount
\$89.5M

Number of Funding Rounds
4

Lead Investors
Sorenson Capital, Greycroft, High Alpha, Point72 Ventures, Gradient

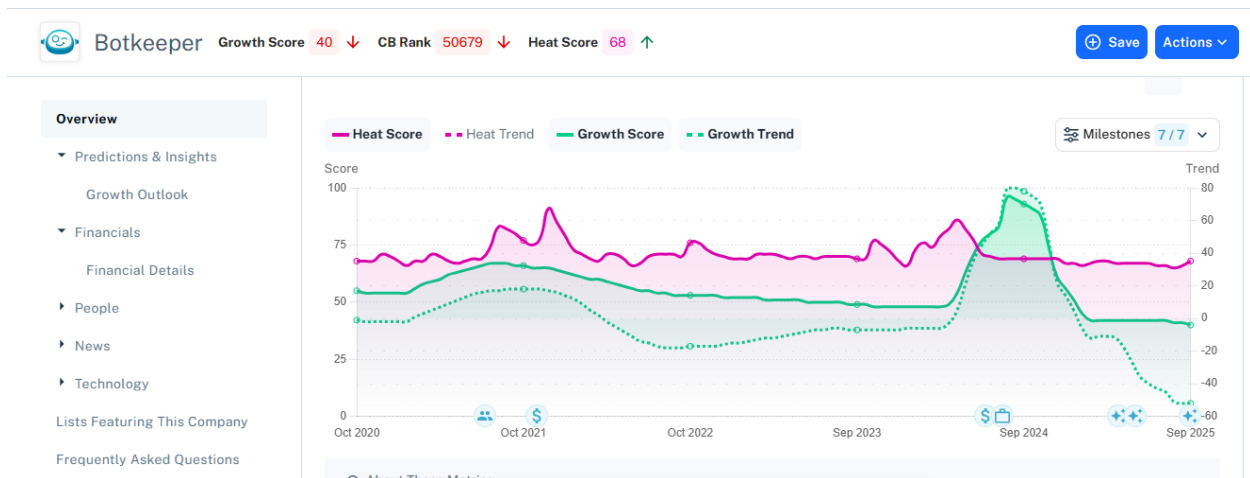
Announced Date	Transaction Name	Number of Investors	Money Raised	Lead Investors
Nov 4, 2021	 Series C - Botkeeper	1	\$42M	Grand Oaks Capital
Jun 18, 2020	 Series B - Botkeeper	8	\$25M	Point72 Ventures
Nov 21, 2018	 Series A - Botkeeper	3	\$18M	Gradient, Greycroft
Jan 25, 2018	 Seed Round - Botkeeper	6	\$4.5M	Ignition Partners

[View Financial Details >](#)

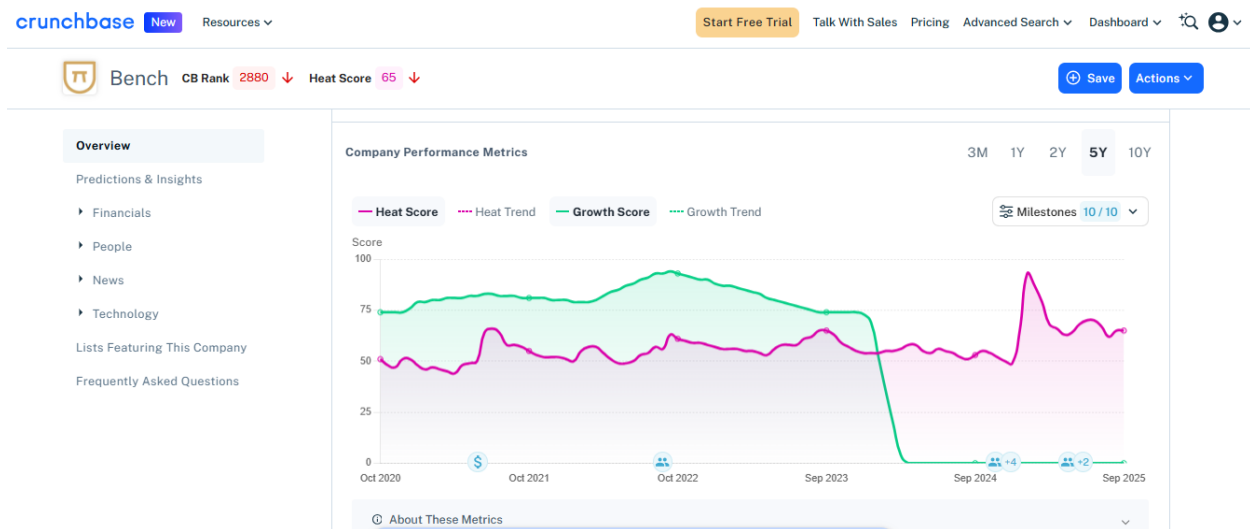


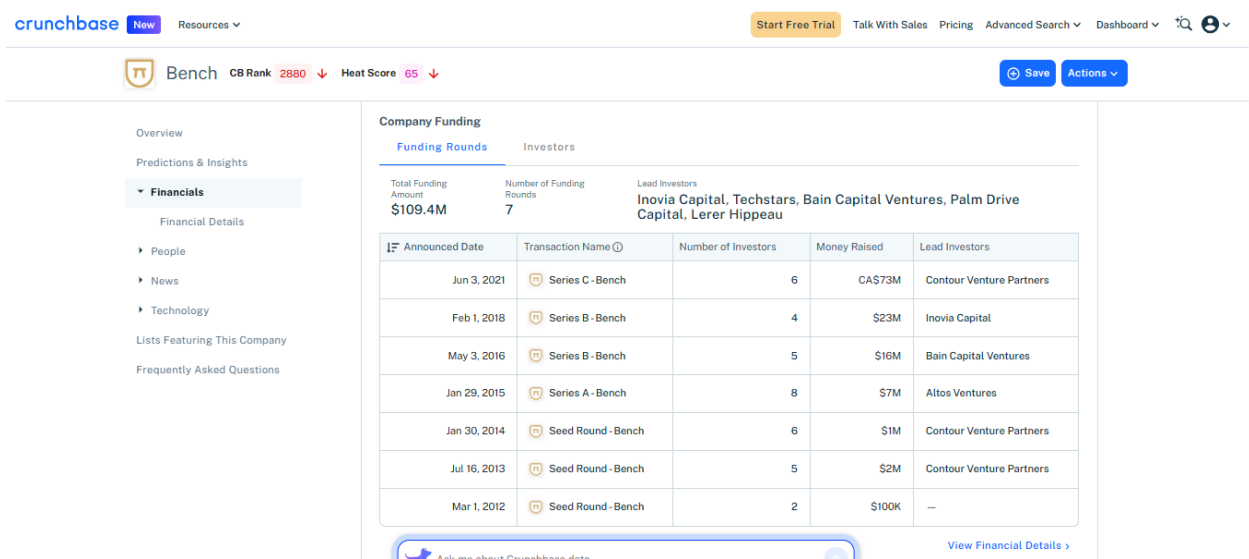
Ask me about Crunchbase data



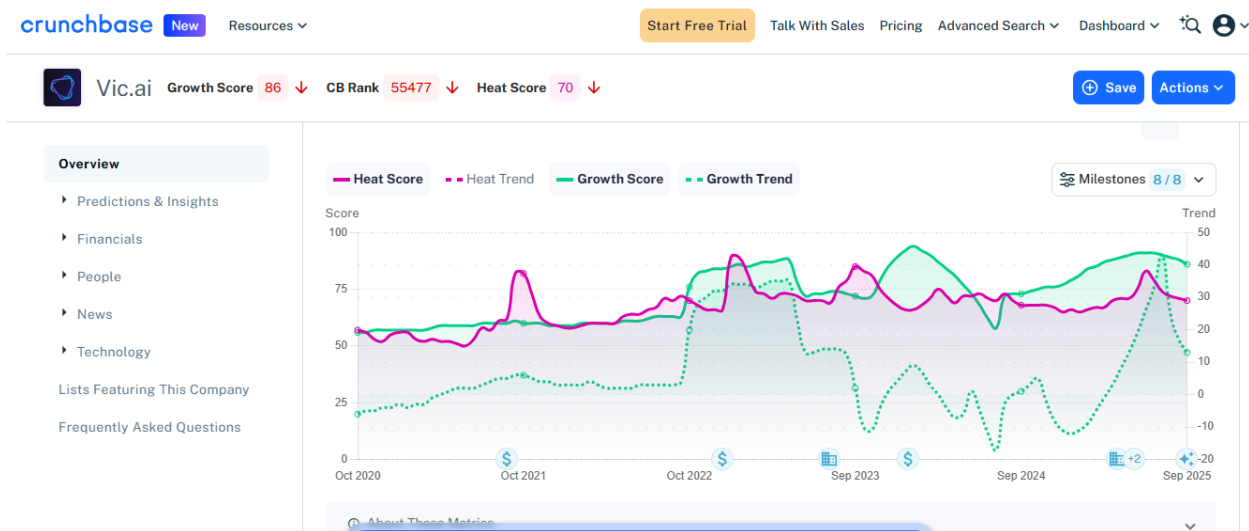


2) Bench accounting by mainstreet:





3) Vic.ai:



Overview

Predictions & Insights

Financials

Financial Details

People

News

Technology

Lists Featuring This Company

Frequently Asked Questions

Company Funding

Funding Rounds

Investors

Total Funding Amount
\$114.7M

Number of Funding Rounds 5

Lead Investors
ICONIQ Growth, Notable Capital, Cowboy Ventures, Costanoa Ventures, Connectivity Ventures Fund

Announced Date	Transaction Name	Number of Investors	Money Raised	Lead Investors
Dec 13, 2022	Series C - Vic.ai	4	\$52M	ICONIQ Growth, Notable Capital
Sep 1, 2021	Series B - Vic.ai	4	\$50M	ICONIQ Growth
Sep 8, 2019	Series A - Vic.ai	4	\$11.2M	Notable Capital
Aug 1, 2017	Seed Round - Vic.ai	5	\$1.5M	Cowboy Ventures
Apr 15, 2017	Convertible Note - Vic.ai	2	—	—

4) Xero:

Overview

Predictions & Insights

Financials

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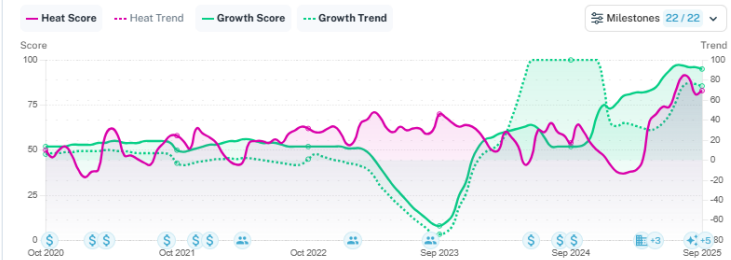
Lists Featuring This Company

Frequently Asked Questions

Growth Score 95 ↓ -1 pts in past quarter Heat Score 83 ↑ 10 pts in past quarter

Company Performance Metrics

3M 1Y 2Y **5Y** 10Y



crunchbase

New

Resources

Start Free Trial

Talk With Sales

Pricing

Advanced Search

Dashboard

Xero

Growth Score 95

CB Rank 3542

Heat Score 83

Save

Actions

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Frequently Asked Questions

Total Funding Amount

\$1.6B

Number of Funding Rounds

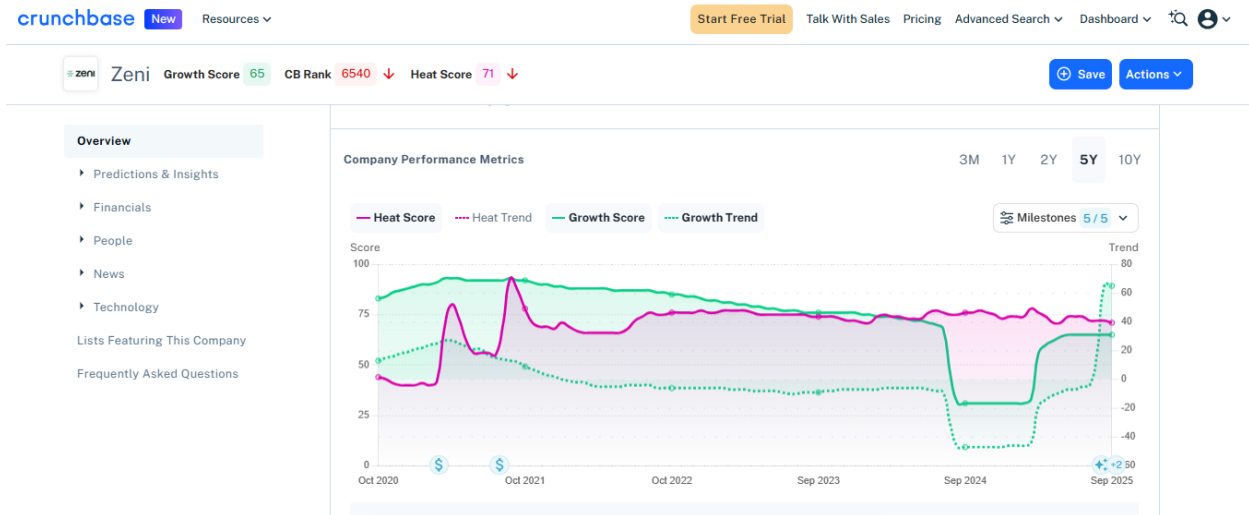
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Lead Investors

Accel, Founders Fund, TCV, Valar Ventures, Callaghan Innovation

Announced Date	Transaction Name	Number of Investors	Money Raised	Lead Investors
Jun 5, 2024	Post-IPO Debt - Xero	—	\$925M	—
Sep 8, 2021	Grant - Xero	1	NZ\$79.6K	Callaghan Innovation
Oct 23, 2020	Grant - Xero	1	NZ\$84.6K	Callaghan Innovation
Sep 26, 2018	Post-IPO Debt - Xero	—	\$300M	—
Apr 18, 2017	Post-IPO Equity - Xero	1	\$26.4M	TCV
Aug 1, 2016	Post-IPO Equity - Xero	1	—	—
Feb 24, 2015	Post-IPO Equity - Xero	2	\$110.8M	Accel
Oct 13, 2013	Post-IPO Equity - Xero	2	\$150M	—
Nov 29, 2012	Post-IPO Equity - Xero	2	\$49M	Matrix Capital Management
Feb 3, 2012	Post-IPO Equity - Xero	4	\$16.6M	Valar Ventures

5) Zeni:



 **Zeni** **Growth Score** 65 **CB Rank** 6540 ↓ **Heat Score** 71 ↓

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- Predictions & Insights
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Company Funding

Funding Rounds		Investors		
Total Funding Amount \$47.5M		Number of Funding Rounds 3	Lead Investors Elevation Capital, Sierra Ventures, Liquid 2 Ventures, Firebolt Ventures, Dragon Capital	
📅 Announced Date	📄 Transaction Name	Number of Investors	Money Raised	Lead Investors
Aug 4, 2021	📄 Series B - Zeni	9	\$34M	Elevation Capital
Mar 9, 2021	📄 Series A - Zeni	8	\$11.5M	Saama
Sep 1, 2019	📄 Seed Round - Zeni	3	\$2M	Twin Ventures

[View Financial Details >](#)

Task 2- Website & Product Feature Analysis of Hellobooks:

Hellobooks.ai

FEATURES:

- Categorization (Use AI to automatically categorize)
- Clean Up (Optimize process)
- Scalable (Support businesses of all sizes)
- Chat Feature (get help and support instantly)
- Advance Reporting (generate detailed reports with AI)
- Taxation & Auditing (keep your financial records organized)
- Easy debug (Quickly identify and fix errors)
- Cloud feature (securely store your files on the cloud)
- Task manager (manages communication and tasks)
- OCR Scanning (bill Matching/Scanning with AI)

Industry Coverage:

- Manufacturing
- Construction
- IT Sector
- Lawyers
- Education
- Franchises
- Jewellery
- Mining

Task 3- Feature Suggestions for Growth:

- 1) Our Services need need better marketing. We should focus on attracting more customers and displaying pricing clearly on our main webpage.
- 2) Let's consider xero because it higher no of reviews. We should also include features like seasonal pricing.
- 3) We should ensure that we have robust customiation options.
- 4) We need to be accurate in providing monthly and annual reports.
- 5) Our pricing should be affordable, and we should remain aware of potential software or banking issues.

SUMMARY:

Hello sir,

I really enjoyed working on this assignment.

- Firstly, I gathered details such as the year of foundation and associated members, from companies official([Bench](#),[Botkeeper](#),[Vic.ai](#),[xero](#),[zeni](#)) linkedin page.
- Secondl, I got the details of total funding, recent funding and funding type from [chrunbase website](#).
- Thirdly, I reviwed customer feedback for each company from [G2](#) and [capterra](#).
- Finally, I suggested a few imporvements based on the comparsion with top companies and their low-rated areas.

To be frank, our HelloBooks.ai already offers servral features that other companies are not currently providing. I believe that in the coming years, HelloBooks.ai.ai will gain greater recognition and adoption among users.